

Μόσχος ὁ Συρακούσιος

Moschus of Syracuse and the Bucolic Tradition

eul_aid: mdu

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Δωρὶς βουκολική [Doric Bucolic](#)
Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Moschus of Syracuse was a Hellenistic bucolic poet of the 2nd century BCE, traditionally considered a pupil of Theocritus and a contemporary of Bion. His epithet indicates his origin in Syracuse, Sicily, the foundational city of the bucolic genre, but no further biographical details survive.

His small surviving corpus includes the miniature epic *Europa*, which narrates Zeus's abduction of Europa. Other notable works are *Love the Runaway* and the *Epitaph on Bion*, a pastoral elegy lamenting the poet Bion. A handful of minor fragments are also attributed to him.

Moschus is a significant figure in the Hellenistic bucolic tradition. *Europa* is an important early example of the epyllion, or "little epic," focusing on a single myth with vivid description. The *Epitaph on Bion* became a key model for pastoral elegy. His polished style and contributions to these genres secured his place as a canonical bucolic poet.

Works (6)

- Ἐπιγράμματα · [Epigrams](#) · 35 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα · [Epitaph for Bion](#) · 127 passages
- Ἔρως δραπέτης · [Eros the Runaway](#) · 30 passages
- Εὐρώπη · [Europe](#) · 166 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Βουκολικῆς Ποίησεως · [Fragments of Bucolic Poetry](#) · 26 passages
- Μεγάρα · [Megara](#) · 125 passages